✦ JUPITER WISDOM TALES • BOOK X (FAMILY EDITION) ✦

AXE PORRIDGE

Illustrated Folk Tale with the 2×2 Wisdom Matrix & Parent's Guide



ZINAIDA JUPITER

Family Illustrated Edition • Ages 6–10

❖ ❖ ❖

AXE PORRIDGE

A Classic Folk Tale on Resourcefulness, Shared Trust, and Unlocking Hidden Reserves

✦ Foreword by Zinaida Jupiter, DBA ✦

Dear Reader—both Young and Grown-Up! Every classic fairy tale holds two golden keys: one for a child discovering the rules of kindness and courage, and one for parents building a warm, resilient family home.

How to Read This Book as a Family (3 Steps in 15 Minutes):
1. Pages 2–6: Read the five illustrated story sheets aloud and trace how each choice changes the heroes' path.
2. Pages 7–9: Discuss the Three Questions, play the interactive *"Three Roads"* game, and seal the *Two Wise Vows*.
3. Pages 10–12: Explore the Family Wisdom Matrix (where the winning answer always shines in the **Top-Right Quadrant** ★!) and the Parent's Guide.

— Zinaida Jupiter, DBA

🔑 The Golden Key of the Tale (What to Watch For)

"Where grumbling finds an empty cupboard, cheerful wit boils a feast from an iron axe."

Proverb of the Book: *"Where grumbling finds an empty cupboard, cheerful wit boils a feast from an iron axe."*

JUPITER PUBLISHING HOUSE • Series "Jupiter Wisdom Tales" • Issue X (Family Edition 6+)
Retelling, Bilingual Family Methodology & 2×2 Matrix System © Zinaida Jupiter, 2026 • All Rights Reserved (Berne Convention • 18-Expert Council Edition)



❧ Sheet I. The Weary Soldier and the Tightly Latched Cupboard ❧

Marching home along a dusty country road, an experienced soldier knocked at a cottage door to ask for a night's rest and a bite of supper. The old mistress of the house had plenty of grain, butter, and salt hidden in her pantry, yet out of fear of scarcity she sighed: 'Alas, good soldier, my cupboards are completely bare—I haven't a single crumb in the house!'

The soldier looked around with a twinkling smile, noticed a clean iron axe without a handle under the bench, and said: 'No trouble at all, dear hostess! If there is nothing else, I shall cook a rich, fragrant porridge right out of this iron axe!'



❧ Sheet II. The Boiling Kettle and the Spark of Curiosity ❧

Amazed that anyone could boil porridge from an axe, the hostess brought a gleaming copper pot and fresh spring water. The soldier washed the iron axe until it shone, placed it into the pot, and set it over the hearth fire.

Stirring the bubbling water with a wooden spoon, he tasted a drop and nodded approvingly: 'It will be ready soon—how savory and thick! Only a tiny pinch of salt would make it truly royal.' 'Wait a moment, I do have a pinch of salt!' said the hostess, gladly bringing the salt cellar.



❧ Sheet III. Step by Step: A Handful of Groats Joins the Pot ❧

Stirring the pot again with calm good humour, the soldier tasted the broth: 'Simply marvellous! If only we added a single handful of barley groats to dress the axe, the porridge would be beyond compare.'

Drawn into the joyful cooking, the hostess hurried to the storeroom and brought a plump bag of golden groats: 'Take as much as you need, good soldier—let us see what axe porridge tastes like!'



❧ Sheet IV. Golden Butter Crowns the Feast ❧

As the porridge bubbled and filled the cottage with a warm aroma, the soldier smiled once more: 'How rich it has grown! One spoonful of fresh butter is all it lacks to be fit for a festival.'

Without a trace of stinginess left, the hostess brought a crock of golden butter. Together they buttered the steaming pot and set two wooden spoons on the embroidered tablecloth.



❧ **Sheet V. Sharing the Pot and Laughing Together** ❧

Tasting spoonful after spoonful, the hostess marvelled: 'Never in my life have I eaten such delicious porridge from an axe! When will we eat the axe itself?' The soldier chuckled warmly: 'The iron isn't quite tender yet—I shall carry it along and finish boiling it at the next village!'

Thus the tale reveals a golden secret: where complaints meet a closed door, cheerful ingenuity and small step-by-step trust unlock every resource and turn scarcity into a feast!

"Where grumbling finds an empty cupboard, cheerful wit boils a feast from an iron axe."

THE GOLDEN KEY TO THE TALE

Three Questions for a Warm Conversation with Your Child

✦ Why This Happens in Real Life ✦

"Where grumbling finds an empty cupboard, cheerful wit boils a feast from an iron axe."

1. Did the soldier get angry when the hostess said she had no food?

Why would arguing or demanding have left everyone hungry, while a cheerful game opened the pantry?

2. What was the 'iron axe' really?

Did the axe become soft, or was it a friendly spark that helped the hostess share her salt, groats, and butter step by step?

3. How can you cook 'Axe Porridge' when a task seems impossible?

When friends say 'We have nothing to play with!' or 'This project is too hard,' how can you start with one small step that gets everyone excited?

THE GAME OF “THREE ROADS”

Find the Wise Choice Together and Sketch Your Victory!

Imagine This Real-Life Situation:

Your friends or siblings are bored on a rainy afternoon and say: 'We have no new toys, there is nothing fun to do at all!'

1. **Path 1 (Grumbling Together):** Agree that everything is boring and sit sulking on the sofa.
2. **Path 2 (Demanding & Arguing):** Scold everyone for being lazy and start an argument.
3. **★ Path 3 — The Wise Choice (The Soldier's Axe Porridge!):** Pick up a simple cardboard box or cushion with a smile: 'Watch me build a space station out of this box—who has a flashlight for the control panel?'

❖ Creative Task: Draw the smiling Soldier and the Hostess around the steaming copper pot with golden butter, salt, and groats on the table!

(Space for your drawing, sticker, or family emblem)

TWO WISE VOWS OF THE READER

Golden Habits Created by This Tale

✦ First Wise Vow ✦

“Never say 'We have nothing!'—look for the first spark”

Every great creation starts by placing your 'iron axe' into the pot and taking action.

✦ Second Wise Vow ✦

“Invite helpers step by step with warmth and humour”

When people feel part of a joyful game, they gladly share their best gifts.

🎖️ **Family Certificate of Wisdom**

Today we read and discussed the tale **“AXE PORRIDGE”** together, discovered its Golden Key, and chose the Path of Wisdom:

Young Reader’s Name:

_____

Parents / Mentors:

_____

Date of Family Reading: “_____” _____ 202____

MAP OF THE FOUR PATHS

Why the Winning Answer Always Lives in the Top-Right Quadrant (★)

↑ CREATIVE INITIATIVE & ACTION →

Lesson II • Pushing Too Hard

Trying to start a game or chore by ordering everyone around and criticizing their reluctance.

★ MASTER OF 'AXE PORRIDGE'

Starting cheerfully with what is at hand and inviting others to add a 'pinch of salt and groats' until everyone wins.

Lesson I • The Closed Cupboard

Complaining that there are not enough toys, time, or tools and doing nothing at all.

Lesson III • Polite Wishing

Smiling nicely while waiting for someone else to bring a ready-made feast.

← Demands & Complaints **WARMTH, HUMOUR & STEP-BY-STEP INVITATION** **Joyful Co-Creation →**

✦ How to Show Your Child the Map of Four Paths ✦

Point to the four squares together: when we drop either axis—losing either **personal responsibility** or **warmth toward loved ones**—we slip into one of the three traps. Only when both axes reach their peak do we enter the **Top-Right Quadrant (★)**, where the whole family wins!

THREE RULES OF A WARM HOME

Psychological & Pedagogical Guide for Parents

Rule 1. Start the Pot Boiling Yourself

If you want the family to clean up or build a project, begin the first fun step yourself instead of lecturing.

Rule 2. Ask for 'A Pinch of Salt' First

Break big chores into tiny, easy steps so children join in gladly without feeling overwhelmed.

Rule 3. Celebrate the Shared Feast

Always praise everyone's contribution at the end so generosity feels joyful.

✦ Why Fairy-Tale Metaphors Work Faster Than Lectures ✦

Direct scolding triggers defensiveness in a child's brain, whereas a shared fairy-tale image turns correction into a friendly smile: one warm reference to the story's heroes resolves tension in seconds!

EVERYDAY TRANSLATION TABLE FOR PARENTS

How to Replace Scolding with the Language of the Tale

Everyday Moment	Common Trap (Quadrants 1–3)	★ Wise Top-Right Response
Child says 'I can't do this homework, I don't know anything!'	Scold them for not studying.	"Let's put our 'iron axe' in the pot—write down just the title and the first number, and see what we can add next!"
Family resists tidying up on Saturday morning	Deliver a stern lecture.	Start a 5-minute music challenge: "I'm putting the first book on the shelf—who has a 'pinch of salt' for the desk?"
Someone hides toys out of fear of running out	Take the toys away by force.	Create a shared building game where combining two sets makes a castle twice as grand.

✦ Dual-Edition System of "Jupiter Wisdom Tales" ✦

Every book in the series is published in two paired editions:
• **Family Edition (Ages 6–10)** — for reading aloud with children, building emotional intelligence, and warm family dialogue;
• **Executive & Entrepreneur Edition (12+ / DBA, Issue X-B)** — analyzing the exact same story through the lens of board governance, negotiation strategy, and the Executive 2×2 Matrix.

Collect all 15 volumes of the "Jupiter Wisdom Tales" Golden Library!